LESSON 2

Goin' Home

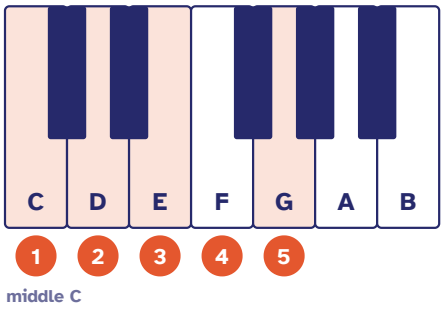
The slow tune from Dvořák's *New World* Symphony, written in 1893 while he was far from home in America. Later it was given words: a song about going home.

IN THIS SONG **the C position** **a skip: E up to G** **the semibreve** **fingers 1 2 3 5**

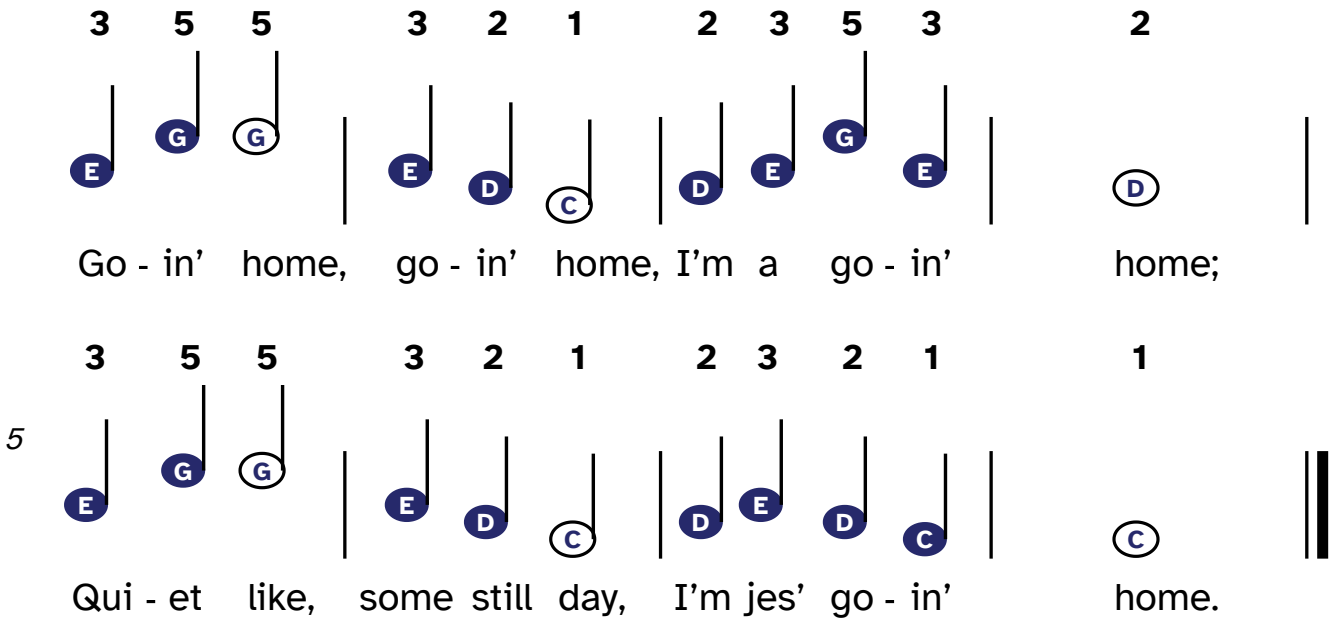
LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it with the words, then on the letter names.



Your hand: the C position. Thumb on middle C, one finger on each key up to G. This song uses 1, 2, 3 and 5.
The skip. E jumps up to G, right over F.



THE WOW MOMENT
☆ **Play it with the string quartet.** Scan the code, choose the quartet, and your notes ride on real strings, the way Dvořák heard them. Then stamp your **passport**: Dvořák.

☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Sang it with the words** ☐ **Sang the letter names**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

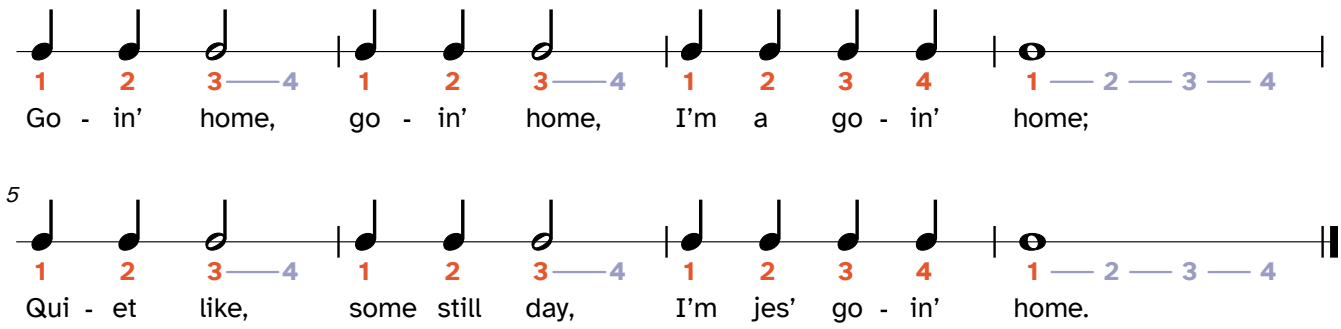
Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE BEAT

Count 1 2 3 4 in every bar: four beats a bar now.
Walk on a beat; hold a minim for two; hold a semibreve for the whole bar.

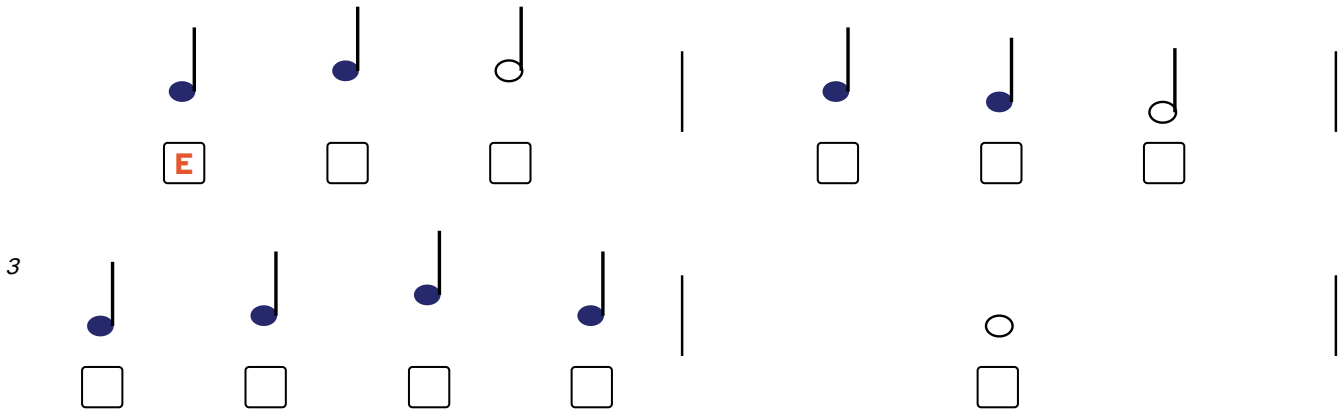
THE NOTES

- **crotchet: walk** — 1 beat ●
- **minim: hold** — 2 beats ●●
- **semibreve: hold-2-3-4** — 4 beats ●●●●



THE NOTES

Write C, D, E or G in each box of the first four bars. Then circle the skip: E straight up to G.

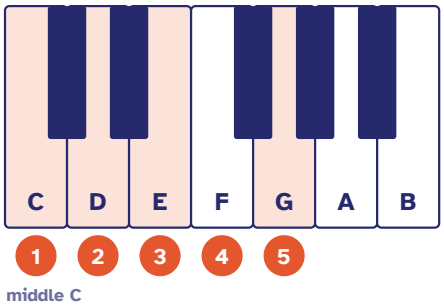


SPOT THE MISTAKE Your teacher plays the song with one wrong note. Put up your hand when you hear it, then find it on the page.

- ☐ **Said it in time**
- ☐ **Clapped and counted**
- ☐ **Wrote the letter names**
- ☐ **Found the skip**
- ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

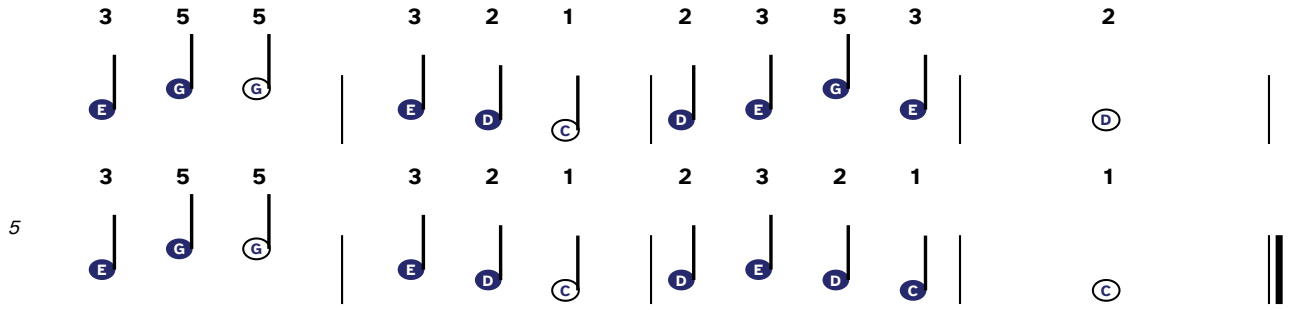
3 Play it

The C position, all five fingers ready: the right hand, then the left, an octave lower.

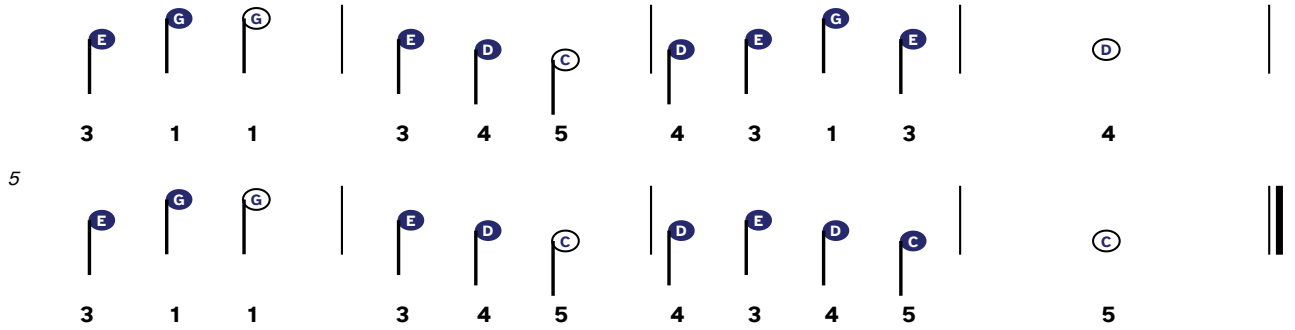


Right hand: thumb on middle C, 1 2 3 up to E, 5 on G. **Left hand:** an octave lower: 5 on C, 4 on D, 3 on E, thumb on G.

R RIGHT HAND 1 2 3 5



L LEFT HAND 5 4 3 1, an octave lower



4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can sing it with the words ☐ I can find the skip

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
Right hand				
Left hand				

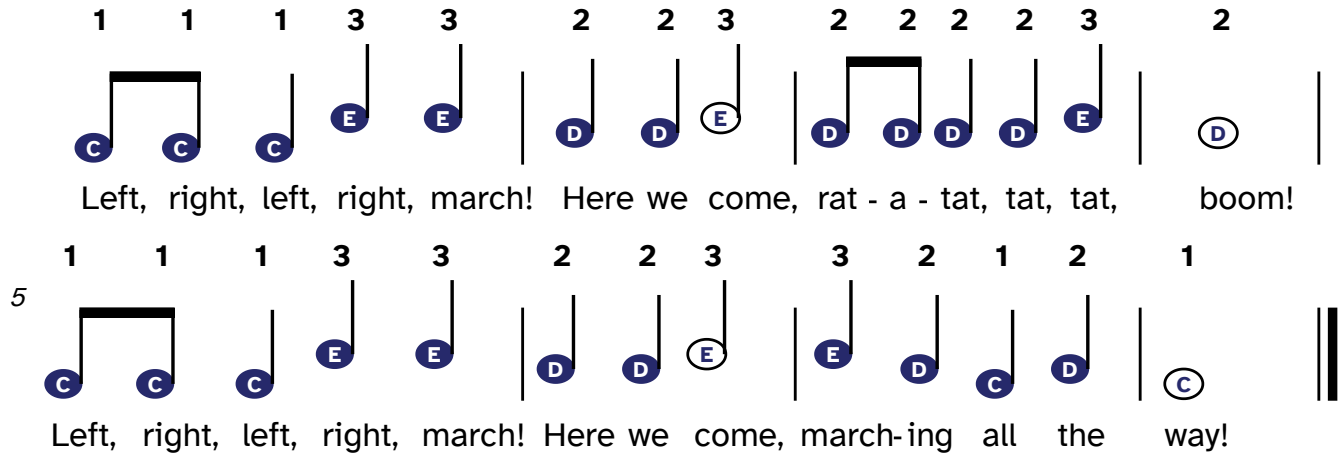
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways: a march on three keys, then a train that jumps the skip.

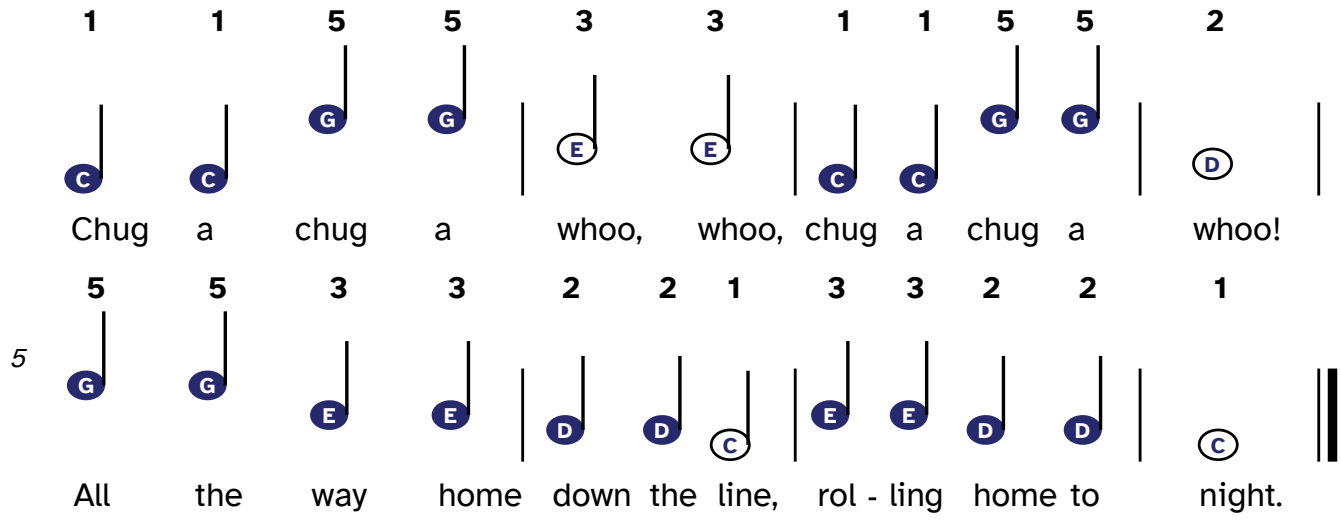
TOY SOLDIERS

A march, crisp and steady: C, D and E, a skip from C to E, and one long BOOM to hold. Sing along!



NIGHT TRAIN

A train rolling home through the dark: thumb and 5 jump C to G; the long whoo is a semibreve.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **Eyes closed: feel the skip, E up to G**
- ☐ **Sleepy: slow and soft, like evening**
- ☐ **Up high: an octave higher**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Right hand, twice
3. Left hand, twice
4. Play it with the quartet

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Toy Soldiers** ☐ **Played Night Train**